

ILIKEITDEEP · A GUIDED JOURNAL

Still Standing

A Journal for After the Affair



printable pdf · 18 guided questions · for the betrayed

WELCOME

Before You Begin



Being cheated on doesn't just break your heart.
It breaks your story — the one you thought you were living.
This journal is where you start writing what's true now.

A few honest promises about these pages:
They will not rush you to forgive. They will not tell you
to stay or to leave. They will not pretend this is small.

They will help you get the storm out of your head
and onto paper, where you can finally look at it.

Betrayal is a real trauma. If the ground won't stop shaking,
a therapist — especially one who knows betrayal recovery —
can help you rebuild. You don't have to white-knuckle this.

STARTING POINT

The Day the Story Broke



Write what happened, just the facts, in your own words. Getting it out of the loop in your head and onto this page is the first act of taking your story back.

PART ONE

The Wreckage



*You're allowed to be exactly as devastated,
furious, and confused as you are.*

What feelings are hitting you right now? Name them all — even the ones that contradict each other.



What do you keep replaying, and what question is the replay trying to answer?



What did you lose besides trust? Name everything — plans, safety, friendships, the future you pictured.



What are you most angry about? Let it be ugly on this page. It's allowed here.



What lies are you tempted to believe about yourself because of what they did?



What do you wish people understood about what this actually feels like?



PART TWO

Sorting the Blame



*Their choice belongs to them. Your healing
belongs to you.*

*Write this in your own words, then answer honestly:
whose choice was the betrayal?*



What red flags do you now see — not to blame yourself, but to trust your gut's track record?



What did their betrayal reveal about THEM — their character, their coping, their honesty?



*What parts of the relationship were real to you?
Those don't stop being real.*



What do you need from them right now — answers, distance, accountability — whether or not they can give it?



*If your best friend was living your exact situation,
what would you want fiercely for her?*



PART THREE

Standing Back Up



*Healing isn't deciding about them. It's
returning to yourself.*

What do you need to feel safe again — in your home, your body, your daily life?



*What decisions do NOT have to be made today?
Give yourself permission to not know yet.*



Who is on your side? List your people, even if the list is short right now.



What piece of yourself did you shrink or set aside in that relationship that you want back?



*What would trusting yourself again look like — not
them, YOU?*



Write to yourself one year from now. What do you hope she knows? What do you promise her?



For the 2 A.M. Spirals



The replays love the night shift. Check the circuit-breakers you'll keep nearby.

- ☐ Put the phone in another room — no checking, no detective work tonight
- ☐ Write the racing thought here instead of texting it
- ☐ Cold water on your face, ten slow breaths
- ☐ Say out loud: 'their choice, not my worth'
- ☐ Step outside or open a window for one minute
- ☐ Play the playlist that steadies you, not the one that wrecks you
- ☐ Eat something, drink water — heartbreak forgets the basics
- ☐ Text a safe person, even just 'bad night'
- ☐ Move: walk, stretch, clean one drawer — give the adrenaline a job
- ☐ Remind yourself: no big decisions after midnight

BONUS · KEEP THIS PAGE

Proof I'm Still Standing



Every day you get through, every boundary you hold, every small return of yourself — record it. On the bad days, this page is your receipts.

























BEFORE YOU CLOSE THIS JOURNAL

A Note, From One Human to Another



Someone broke a promise that was supposed to protect you.
And you are still here — hurting, yes, but standing.

Whatever you decide about the relationship, on your own
timeline, remember: their betrayal is a chapter
in your story. It is not the title of it.

Betrayal trauma is heavy to carry alone. A good therapist
or support group can hold some of the weight while you heal.
Reaching out isn't giving up — it's how the strong survive.



*Their choice. Not your worth. Still
standing.*



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